

ESCAPEBANDEDITED

Travel Radio Australia, this month we're in Gladstone in Queensland and we have a very interesting group here. It's called the Escape Band, I think it is, and I have the members of the band here. Now they travel around Australia doing all sorts of fantastic shows.

Can you introduce yourself? Hi, I'm Natalie. Hi, I'm Brett. I'm Lindsay.

And tell me guys, you're here in Gladstone doing a Taylor Swift tribute show this weekend and a country show and tell us a bit about what you do and how. First of you, Natalie. Okay, so tonight we've got our country tribute show.

We play songs from the 60s to today, from Keith Urban to Patsy Cline to The Chicks and so on and so forth. It's a five piece and it's myself up front with Lindsay West, who's here with us now. That's just one of the shows.

We also do a Taylor Swift tribute show called Burning Red. That's a full concert production show. We do anything from a four piece up to a nine or ten piece in that show.

Lindsay over here also runs a couple of great shows as well. Now Lindsay, tell me a bit about the stuff you do. Yes, I've got my finger in a few pies.

The main show that I do around Australia is called Kiss This, which is a kiss tribute show and Brett, who's here in Escape, he does that show with me. He plays the Gene Simmons role and I'm the Paul Stanley role in the Kiss show. I also do a Bon Jovi tribute show where I play the role of John Bon Jovi.

Among other things like Escape, I also help out with production and stage hand assistant, runner, dog's body. Yeah, a bit of anything. Yeah, bodyguard.

You're a touring band around country Australia and the cities, of course, because you do shows all over the place. It must be a really fantastic experience to see all these small towns in Australia. Tell us about some of the experiences you've had.

Well, yeah, we actually do get to see quite a bit of Australia. We've been to a lot of places, a lot of small towns, obviously main places. You know, we've been up this way, Ellie Beach.

Last year, we were there. Yeah, the Ellie Beach Hotel, wasn't it? We're at with the Kiss This band. Yeah, pretty much all around.

Actually, with the Kiss This band, we did a cruise as well, didn't we? We did the Royal Caribbean. That was an experience, to say the least. But yeah, that was great.

Took us right down to Tasmania from Queensland and great way to see Australia. Absolutely.

And live music is so important to these venues because these little towns all around Australia, they really need this influx of entertainment.

And I suppose you're a bit of stars when you come to town sometimes, right? I don't know. The kids think we are. Oh, definitely.

With the Taylor Swift show, it's huge. They're very cute. They just make the show.

On the stage, like they did in Malala. Malala, we had them, we literally turned around at the end of the night. I think I was turning off my bass rig and I literally turned back and there was about 10 kids that had jumped up on stage.

So I think one kid got up and then they all just hurdled up on the stage and was like, what's going on here? But yeah, it was good. They just love it. Come and say hi and high five Natalie and yeah.

What's some of your favourite parts of Australia to tour in? Natalie, first of all, I love Queensland and I'm not just saying that because we're here, but I've always loved Queensland, especially the sunny coast. We go to the Gold Coast a fair bit in Escape Band. This is the first time we've been here for the Taylor show.

Hopefully there'll be more in this part of the world. Love it. Love Tassie.

Haven't been there for a while, but we are actually heading there with the Taylor show in September. I haven't actually played there for maybe about 10 or so years. We used to go there a lot as a cover band.

Really looking forward to that one at the casinos there. Again, same as Natalie, it's always nice to come up to sunny Queensland. So we do enjoy that.

To get out of Melbourne, obviously we're Melbourne locals. So it's great to escape that. Do head up north a lot.

We seem to play up Mull Whaler. I know I mentioned that before, but we've played there a few times and it's always great heading up there. The people up there are great.

The staff look after us and yeah, it's always good to get up there. Now, Lindsay, this Kiss show, it sounds fantastic and I can see you in the makeup. You don't have the makeup on now.

Were you a fan when you were a kid and it just went on from there or how did that work? I was a Kiss fan from very young and I never sort of grew out of it. So whether that's a sign of being emotionally stunted or whatever, I don't know. But look, of all the different acts I've done and still do, the Kiss tribute show is still my favourite one.

It's the hardest work because you've got two hours of makeup each show and you've got

pyrotechnics and fire breathing and bombs and guitars you have to smash and yeah, more lights than the usual act and yeah, it's hard work, but it's definitely the most fulfilling. And then you've got the Jon Bon Jovi show too and I can see the resemblance there as well. Every time you mention these artists, he sort of like morphs into this artist.

Yeah, look, I've tried my hand at several tribute shows over the years. It's mainly about getting work that are going to connect with more people and it's just a sign of the times is that there aren't sort of many new acts rising to the stature of a lot of the acts from yesteryear. So tribute shows tend to connect with a lot more people.

I'm a big fan of a few things from childhood that stuck and stayed with me and Bon Jovi is one of them. It's an easy tribute show to do from the point of view that they've got a lot of hits and that they're everywhere. Like anytime you sit in a bistro, you'll hear one of their songs.

It's about getting something back from performing and being able to connect with more people and get better work. As you say, these original songs from the 70s, the 80s, the 90s, the younger musicians are really not making those iconic things anymore that everyone loves together, right? It's all changed a bit now. It's hard to just keep coming up with new things and I guess that's where the landscape changes and country has had a massive run those last 10 years because that's something fresh and they've kind of gone a lot country pop and mixed up.

It's completely different from the 90s country, the stuff that you hear now from Brooks and Dungarth back in the 80s and 90s compared to what's coming out now. We were talking about this earlier, there's even an element of hip-hop that's come into country now and if people can grasp it and people are with that kind of music in other genres as well, just that moving on and coming up with something fresh. Well there are Linkin Park tribute bands that are smashing it too.

They were playing massive stadiums overseas so there are still some bands that are coming out but just few and far between unfortunately. Well it's great to have you guys on the program and thank you very much for sitting down with us here at the Queen's Hotel here in Gladstone in Queensland. That's 650 kilometers north of Brisbane and do you guys have a tour bus? How do you do that? No, we fly.

So you're not in the grungy tour bus anymore. The distances are quite enormous aren't they in Queensland? We drive around Victoria a lot. Everything there, we're driving.

We've got the trailer on the car and we're traveling that way on the van. And how can people find out more about you guys online? So for Escape Band and all of the acts that we do there, just head to escapelivemusic.com and for the Taylor Swift tribute show you can head to taylorswifttribute.au. And what about you Brett? The acts I do, Kiss This, Facebook and Instagram, the same handle, Kiss This Tribute and the This Has Two S's, that gets a lot of people. The Bon Jovi show is again the same handle for both Facebook and Instagram and it's

celebrating Bon Jovi tribute.

And yourself? And always look out for, Lindsay and I are in a original band, so look out for Burn City Saints as well and our handle's exactly that as well at Burn City Saints all over Facebook, Instagram mainly. Natalie and I have delved into some country stuff ourselves and we do James Land which is just a little, I think there was a Lockdowns band that we put together and released a few songs under our own little country duo kind of thing, but there's a few tracks on Spotify that you can check out where we do some original music as well. So James Land, Burn City Saints, check it out.

Thank you guys, I know you've got a show tonight, so break a leg as they say in the entertainment industry, have a great show and thank you for being on the program. Thank you so much for having us.